

Editing Audio

Learning Objectives

- Cut, copy, and paste audio segments in Audacity
- Remove unwanted sections and silence from recordings
- Apply basic trimming to clean up audio

Engage (5-7 minutes)

Think of a radio play where different voices, sounds, and music are joined together smoothly. The editor cuts out mistakes and joins the best parts. Today we learn to edit audio like a radio producer.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Open a recorded audio file in Audacity. Use the selection tool to highlight a section, then cut it. Paste it somewhere else. Try the silence tool on a noisy part. Describe what happens after each action.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Editing audio is like editing text—you select unwanted parts and remove them. The cut tool removes a section, paste places it elsewhere, and silence replaces sound with quiet. Use undo (Ctrl+Z) if you make a mistake. Always keep the original file as backup.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Take a recording with three mistakes—stutter, long pause, and background noise. Use editing tools to fix each: cut the stutter, trim the pause, silence the noise. Save the cleaned version and compare the before and after.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Exit ticket: Name three editing tools in Audacity and what each does. Explain why you should keep the original recording before editing.